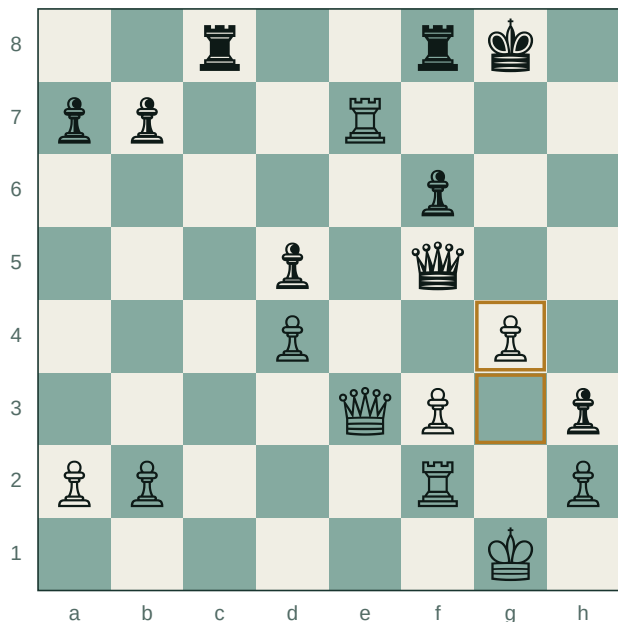


Deflection tactics: Black, move 30

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 30.g4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30...Qb1+ 31. Rf1 Qxb2 32. Qe6+ Kh8

30...Qb1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **31.Rf1**.

31...Qxb2 The queen captures the pawn on b2. Recorded reply: **32.Qe6+**.

32...Kh8 The king moves from g8 to h8.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1**: the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.